

SECURITY
INFORMATION

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STATUS REPORT

Classification cancelled

or changed to

AUTH: Robert J. Friend, Major, USAF

By Robert J. Friend, Major
Signature and Grade

Date 9 SEPT 1960

PROJECT GRUDGE - REPORT NO. 3

PROJECT NO. 10073

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AIR TECHNICAL INTELLIGENCE CENTER
WRIGHT-PATTERSON AIR FORCE BASE
DAYTON, OHIO

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Chief, Air Technical Intelligence Center
Wright-Patterson Air Force Base
Dayton, Ohio

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Date 9 SEPT 1960

This report is the third of a series of monthly status reports of Project Grudge. Each report will be written on or near the last day of the month and will contain a list of all incidents reported during the month covered by the report. The reports that are considered to be outstanding will be summarized in the appendices of the report so that more details can be presented. The overall status of the project will also be presented.

Additional information may be obtained on any incident by directing requests to Chief, Air Technical Intelligence Center, Attention: ATIAA-2c, Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, Dayton, Ohio.

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STATUS OF PROJECT GRUDGE

I. OVERALL STATUS

A. Files

All of the material in ATIC that relates to sightings of unidentified aerial objects has been reviewed and filed. All data on each sighting has been placed in a separate folder and the folders filed chronologically. There are a total of 695 incidents. These vary from nebulous reports from very questionable sources to more factual reports from reasonably reliable sources such as AF pilots, airline pilots and balloon observers.

The factual details of each incident have been placed on 5" by 8" cards and these cards are being cross-indexed. All the cards have been re-produced and cross-indexing is about 50 percent completed. When this phase of the project is finished, it will be possible to make a breakdown of all reported sightings as to the predominant shapes, size, course, geographical locations, etc.

B. Location of Additional Files

During the past month, a trip was made to Washington, D. C. to locate additional data on sightings. It was found that both the D/I library and TOB have such files. In the near future a trip will be made to Washington to review these files and obtain additional sighting reports.

C. Map of Sightings

A map has been prepared, showing all of the sightings in the United States. Colored tacks are used to designate sightings by years.

The plot of sightings shows that there is a concentration of sightings in the area of:

1. Dayton, Ohio
2. Columbus, Ohio
3. White Sands, New Mexico
4. Albuquerque, New Mexico
5. Oak Ridge, Tenn.
6. Camp Hood, Texas

No conclusions can be made or other facts about the distribution of the sightings stated until a further study of the distribution of sightings has been made.

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D. Directives for Reporting Incidents

The directive which outlines the reporting procedures to be used in this project is AFOIN-C/GC-2, letter dated 19 December 1951, subject: "Reporting Information on Unidentified Flying Objects". This directive is not believed to be adequate to cover all phases of the project and it is being revised. The revision of this directive has been given top priority as it is believed that the project cannot function properly until satisfactory reporting channels are set up.

E. Consultants

The consultants that will be obtained to assist in the project have finished their preliminary survey of past work done on the project and will submit their formal proposal during the early part of February. During the past month one of their members accompanied Project Grudge personnel on two interrogations to familiarize them with how reports are investigated.

F. Difficulties in Obtaining Reports

Recently several airline and Air Force pilots have been queried as to their feelings on reporting the sightings of unidentified aerial objects. The queries were predicated by reports that sightings were not being reported due to stigma that has been placed on the project by unfavorable newspaper releases, etc. Only a very few individuals were contacted, however, these people stated that they would be very reluctant to report any type of unidentified object to the Air Force. One pilot summed up the situation by stating, "If a space ship flew wing-tip to wing-tip formation with me, I would not report it." This feeling among people who are in a position to submit good reports is a great handicap to the objective of getting reliable data. The exact nature of some of the objects reported have not been determined, therefore, there is always the possibility that there exists some type of unconventional vehicle possessing extraordinary performance and characteristics. If such a vehicle should appear, its detection would be hampered by the reluctance to report sightings of unusual aerial objects.

A series of briefings of Air Force commanders is being tentatively planned to explain the functions and findings of this project in an attempt to break down the adverse feelings on reporting that are held by many people.

G. Radar Search

In compliance with suggests of the Directorate of Intelligence, a preliminary conference has been held on the possibility of using electronic means to detect and obtain data on the unidentified objects that are being reported. Radar would be used in conjunction with photographic equipment to accomplish this. In the past there have been unexplained radar contacts but whether or not these were due to weather phenomena, malfunction of the sets or actual targets has not been determined.

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Further conferences will be held on this matter. To date, nothing definite has been decided.

H. Briefing of General Garland

On 29 January 1952, Brig Gen W. M. Garland, Assistant for Production, Director of Intelligence, Hq USAF, and members of his staff were briefed as to the status of the project.

II. REPORTS OF SPECIFIC INCIDENTS

A. Inclosed Summary List of Incidents

The inclosed list of incidents is (1) a summary of all incidents reported during the period 1 January 1952 to 31 January 1952; and (2) those incidents reported in Status Report No. 2, dated 31 December 1951, which are still pending or have been closed during the past month.

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DATE	TIME (Local)	LOCATION	DESCRIPTION OF INCIDENT
25 Aug 51	2110	Lubbock, Texas	Group of lights that have been seen on many occasions
25 Aug 51	2158	Albuquerque, N.M.	Dark flying wing type a/c with about 1 1/2 times the
31 Aug 51	1245	Matador, Texas	Pear-shaped aluminum object seemed to hover then leave
10 Oct 51	1010	Minneapolis, Minn.	Round, silver object seen by pilots tracking a balloon
11 Oct 51	0630	Minneapolis, Minn.	Round, silver object seen by pilots tracking balloon
24 Nov 51	1553	Minneapolis, Minn.	Flying wing shaped object.
7 Dec 51	1412	Kansas City, Mo.	Described as perfectly round, with inner core resembling tapered and stubby wings.
7 Dec 51	0815	Oak Ridge, Tenn.	Object appeared to be square, rose and descended three times. Neither radar nor fighter aircraft could make contact.
10 Dec 51	1820 EST	Buffalo, N. Y.	Large, white, extremely brilliant and globular in shape
12 Dec 51	2150	Hastings, Minn.	White object resembling a kite about 100 ft. below clouds
22 Dec 51	0625	Hamden, Ohio	Extremely bright light in sky. Appeared to be hovering
22 Dec 51	1030	Columbus, Ohio	F-84 Pilot observed object which appeared to be a/c with wings seemed to be rolling. An unsuccessful attempt was made to intercept. (See Appendix I)
19 Jan 52	1956	Cedar Keys, Fla.	Large blue-green fireball observed by B-29 crew. Descended to ground.
21 Jan 52	0950	Mitchell AFB, N.Y.	Navy TBM attempted to intercept disc-shaped object with wings. (See Appendix II.)
29 Jan 52	2300 and 2324	Korea	A disk, judged to be 3 ft. in diameter, approached two F-84s. (See Appendix III.)

SIGHTINGS OF UNIDENTIFIED OBJECTS

PORTION OF INCIDENT	LENGTH OF TIME OBSERVED	SOUND	SPEED	
seen on many occasions.	4 Sec.	None	30° Arc/Sec	
about 1 1/2 times the wing span of a B-36.	30 Sec.	None	300-400 mph	
descended to hover then leave the area at high speed.	Several seconds	None	Hovering to high speed	
while tracking a balloon.	2 Min.	None	High	
while tracking balloon and by ground observer team.	Several Minutes	None	High	
	Unknown	None	Hovering	
had inner core resembling fuselage of small a/c with	Approx. 1 Min.	None	Unknown	
ascended and descended three times at high rate of speed. Pilot could make contact.	2 Min.	None	High	
and globular in shape.	15 Sec.	None	240 Knots	300
about 100 ft. below a/c.	3-4 Min.	None	380-400 mph	2
appeared to be hovering.	1 Hr.	None	Hovering	R
appeared to be a/c with no tail assembly. Object was seen. Attempt was made to intercept the object.	1 1/2 Min.	None	Same as F-84	25,000
seen by B-29 crew. Descended and exploded near the	3 Sec.	None	---	---
discussed object with negative results.	Unknown	None	300-500 Knots (Est.)	U
later approached two different B-29's.	5 Min. and 1 Min.	---	Same as B-29	Same

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EED	ALTITUDE	HEADING	SOURCE	ACTION OR COMMENTS
Arc/Sec	Unknown	180°	Varied	Further investigation has produced no new developments. For details of the incident, Status Report No. II. Details of this incident will be published in a special report.
100	1000 ft.	160°	Sandia Base guard and wife	No conclusions - Investigation closed.
ring high	Low to high	90°	Two ladies	No conclusions - Investigation closed.
	High	SE	Balloon Obs.	Further investigation of both of these incidents has lead to no conclusions. The investigation is closed. (See Status Report No. II for details.)
	High	Unknown	Balloon Obs.	
ring	25,000 ft.	90°	AF Pilot	No conclusions.
own	Unknown	NW	Civilian	No conclusions. No further information could be obtained.
	Varied	None	Civilian Guard	No conclusions.
(note	3000-4000 ft.	S to N	USAF Pilot	No conclusions. Probably a fireball of some type.
100 mph	9,000 ft.	Unknown	USAF Pilot	No conclusions
ring	High	—	Civilian	Proved to be "Christmas Star".
as 4	25,000 ft. (Est.)	285°	F-84 Pilot	See Appendix I.
	—	—	B-29 Crew	Fireball type phenomena. No investigation. No conclusions.
500 ots)	Unknown	Varied	Navy Pilot	See Appendix II.
as B-29	Same as B-29	Same as B-29	Members of two B-29 crews	See Appendix III.

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APPENDIX I

Columbus, Ohio - 22 December 1951

I. DISCUSSION OF INCIDENT

On 22 December 1951 at approximately 1030 EST, an F-84 pilot sighted an unidentified object five miles east of Columbus, Ohio. The object, which looked like an aircraft with no tail surfaces, appeared to be rolling on its lateral axis. The object was on a reciprocal heading and higher than the F-86. The pilot made a turn in an attempt to intercept the object but lost it in the sun.

II. STATUS OF INVESTIGATION

At approximately 1000 EST a weather balloon was released from the Columbus Municipal Airport. The wind, which was from the west, would have blown the balloon into the general vicinity of the sighting. More definite information on the balloon launching has been requested.

III. CONCLUSIONS

No conclusions can be made until more information on the balloon launching is obtained.

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APPENDIX II

Mitchell Air Force Base - 22 January 1952

I. DISCUSSION OF INCIDENT

At approximately 0950 EST on 22 January 1952, a U. S. Navy pilot flying a TBM type aircraft sighted a disc-shaped object near Mitchell Air Force Base, New York. The object appeared to be light, "like a nylon parachute canopy", with a dark under surface. It was estimated to be 20 feet to 30 feet in diameter with a 3:1 diameter to thickness ratio.

The object appeared to be circling Mitchell Air Force Base and the observer was able to get near the object by cutting inside on turns.

II. STATUS OF THE INVESTIGATION

Additional information has been requested from Mitchell Air Force Base. No conclusions can be made on data contained in preliminary wire message.

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APPENDIX III

Korea - 29 January 1952

I. DISCUSSION OF INCIDENT

On the night of 29 January 1952 at 2300 and again at 2324, local Korea time, two B-29 crews at different locations observed similar objects near their aircraft. They described them as a disk, approximately three feet in diameter, and with a color similar to the sun. In one instance the object stayed beside the B-29 for five minutes and in the other for one minute.

II. STATUS OF THE INVESTIGATION

More details on this incident have been requested.

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